

Victor M. Bravo Jr.

Aspiring Physician-Scientist | B.S. Biology Candidate | UTSA Honors College
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PROFILE

Biology student and aspiring physician-scientist focused on translational oncology, leptomeningeal disease modeling, and clinically grounded cancer research. Experience spans in vivo model development, bioluminescence imaging workflows, pediatric urgent care, emergency department documentation, free clinic volunteering, and student leadership in medical outreach and Honors mentorship.

EDUCATION

The University of Texas at San Antonio (UTSA) - B.S. in Biology; Minor in Chemistry

Expected Dec 2026 | Honors College, Fall 2024-Present

- Premedical student preparing for MD/PhD-oriented application cycle with emphasis on research depth, service, clinical exposure, and scientific communication.
- Relevant academic interests: cancer biology, physiology, biochemistry, neuroscience, cell biology, and translational medicine.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Undergraduate Researcher - Mays Cancer Center, UT Health San Antonio, Brenner Lab

Summer 2025-Present | Experimental and Developmental Therapeutics Program Affiliate

- Contribute to development of an in vivo mouse model of leptomeningeal disease using tamoxifen-resistant MCF7-luciferase breast cancer cells.
- Support optimization of model variables including cell delivery route, tracer dye selection, estrogen support, IVIS bioluminescence monitoring, and future treatment workflow design.
- Project rationale centers on establishing a reliable disease model that can later support testing of imlunestrant, a next-generation oral selective estrogen receptor degrader, in endocrine-resistant ER+ disease contexts.
- Built familiarity with translational oncology research questions, animal model planning, tumor signal tracking, data organization, and poster-based scientific communication.

Undergraduate Researcher - UTSA CURES / FlyCURE / Genomics Education Partnership coursework

Fall 2025-Spring 2026

- Participated in a yearlong research-based course sequence emphasizing experimental design, data interpretation, collaboration, and scientific presentation.
- Strengthened skills in literature-based reasoning, figure interpretation, technical writing, and communicating methods and results to peers and faculty.

PRESENTATIONS & SCHOLARLY WORK

National Conference on Undergraduate Research (NCUR) 2026 - Student Poster Presenter

Richmond, VA | April 15, 2026 | Poster #1119 | Session 009, 1:00-1:50 PM ET

- Presented undergraduate cancer research connected to development of an in vivo model of leptomeningeal disease and translational therapeutic testing.
- Represented UTSA at a national undergraduate research conference and discussed project rationale, methods, early optimization decisions, and next steps with conference attendees.

UTSA Undergraduate Research Week - Research Presenter

2026

- Presented research progress to the UTSA community and practiced communicating specialized oncology research to mixed scientific and non-specialist audiences.

CLINICAL EXPERIENCE

Medical Assistant - Hopscotch Health Pediatric Urgent Care & Primary Care

San Antonio, TX | September 2025-Present

- Support pediatric urgent care and primary care operations through patient intake, vitals, histories, front desk workflows, faxing, insurance-related tasks, and rooming support.
- Assist with injections and vaccinations under clinic protocols while maintaining patient flow and clear communication with families.
- Use bilingual communication skills to help parents and children feel oriented during visits, especially when anxiety or language barriers are present.

Emergency Department Medical Scribe - Proscribe LLC / Methodist Healthcare sites

San Antonio, TX | 2024-2025

- Documented real-time emergency department encounters, including HPI, ROS, physical exam findings, medical decision-making support, and provider workflow details.
- Gained exposure to high-acuity clinical environments across Methodist Main, Stone Oak, Boerne, and Methodist Children's settings.
- Developed clinical vocabulary, composure in fast-paced settings, and an understanding of physician decision-making under time pressure.

Clinical Volunteer - Corazon Medical Clinic

San Antonio, TX | 08/30/2023- Present

- Volunteer in a free clinic serving underserved and uninsured community members through intake, vitals, triage support, pharmacy-related tasks, charting, and provider-facing patient summaries.

LEADERSHIP & SERVICE

Site Leader - UTSA Volunteers Around the World, Medical Chapter

Medical Team B, Peru | May 26-June 9, 2026

- Lead preparation for a medical outreach trip with approximately 21 interns, including biweekly trainings on intake, vitals, patient interaction, clinic expectations, and country context.
- Coordinate team readiness, mock clinic planning, intern communication, fundraising support, role expectations, and clinic-station workflow planning.
- Selected to continue chapter leadership as Social Chair for 2026-2027, with a goal of strengthening member engagement and measurable chapter growth.

Board Member and Recruitment Chair - Honors College Student Advisory Board (HCSAB), UTSA

San Antonio, TX | 05/01/2025- Present

- Helped develop an Honors peer mentorship program, including mentor and mentee applications, interview questions, scoring rubrics, mentor selection processes, and recruitment messaging.

- Support Honors student engagement by connecting younger students with mentors, campus resources, and leadership opportunities.

Mentee - Pathways to Medicine Program, UT Health San Antonio

12/01/2025- 12/12/2026

- Participate in mentorship, workshops, clinical exposure, mock interview preparation, and professional development aimed at supporting premedical students pursuing physician careers.

Volunteer Coach - Elementary Girls Softball Team

Community Service | Approx. 105 hours

- Helped coach young athletes in softball fundamentals while emphasizing confidence, discipline, persistence, and team-oriented growth.

PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT & AFFILIATIONS

Mays Cancer Center Affiliate Member

Experimental and Developmental Therapeutics Program | 2026-Present

- Connected to cancer research programming, abstracts, symposiums, and volunteer opportunities focused on reducing the cancer burden in South Texas.

Premedical and Student Organizations

UTSA and Long School of Medicine community involvement

- Member in UTSA's Pre-Med Society, Volunteers Around the World- Medical Chapter, Club Pre-Med at Long School of Medicine, LMSA at Long School of Medicine, LATSA, and First Gen Scholars/Scholarship Association.
- Engage in physician exposure, application workshops, mentorship, school tours, networking, and community-building opportunities.

CERTIFICATIONS

Certified Clinical Medical Assistant (CCMA) | Certified Patient Care Technician (C-PCT) | Basic Life Support (BLS)

SELECTED SKILLS

Research	In vivo model development support; leptomenigeal disease model planning; IVIS bioluminescence imaging workflows; tracer dye comparison; tumor signal tracking; literature review; poster communication.
Clinical	Pediatric intake; vitals; patient histories; injections and vaccinations under clinic protocols; emergency department documentation; patient flow; free clinic support.
Leadership	Team training; intern coordination; peer mentorship program design; recruitment messaging; meeting planning; student organization operations.
Communication	Scientific poster presentation; bilingual patient-facing communication; clinical documentation; professional email and team updates; public-facing portfolio development.